

At the Restaurant

Booking / Reservation

I'd like to book a table for two at 7 pm, please.

Menu

wine list, dessert menu, set meal, today's special

Cutlery / Tableware

knives, forks, spoons, condiment dish

Starter / appetizer

bread, salad

Main course

steaks: rare, medium rare, medium, medium well, well done

Dessert

cake, pudding, ice-cream

Vegetarian option

dishes for people who don't eat meat or fish.

Vegan option

dishes for people who don't eat meat, fish, dairy, or any other animal products.

Talk about taste

Flavor: sour, sweet, bitter, salty, spicy, savory, mild, tangy, smoky.

Texture: crispy/crunchy, chewy, tender, tough, juicy, watery, soggy.

Temperature and cooking: hot, cold, undercooked, overcooked, burned.

Freshness: stale, not fresh, a little off.

Other: rich, creamy, oily/greasy, refreshing, fizzy, bland.

Reaction: not what I expected.

Arriving at the restaurant

Hello. We haven't booked a table. Can you fit us in?

Ordering food

Could we see the menu, please?

What do you recommend?

What's your special?

What's your best-seller / most popular?

We'll have what they're having at that table, please!

Dietary needs

Does this dish contain nuts?

Choosing what to eat

We're not ready to order yet. Could you give us a few more minutes, please?

We're ready to order now.

Dealing with problems

If you are given the wrong food: Excuse me — I didn't order this.

If the cutlery isn't clean: Could I have another spoon, please?

If your food isn't hot enough: Could you heat this up a bit more, please?

If you waited too long: Can you check on our food?

Paying for your meal

Could we have the bill, please?

Can I pay by credit card?

Keep the change. (if you pay by cash and want to leave a tip)

Discussion

What is the best restaurant you have been to this year? What did you order?

Do you always order the same dish, or do you like to try something new?

How often do you eat out or order takeout in a normal week?

Have you ever complained about your food in a restaurant? What happened?

Do you like sharing dishes with friends, or do you prefer your own plate?